Digital Literacy
Project Report

Project Details	
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Introduction

This project report documents my work as a Student Digital Ambassador.

Across five tasks, I explored key aspects of digital literacy - from creating an awareness infographic, setting up a professional digital portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, understanding proper email etiquette, and learning about cybercrime and its prevention.

Each task built on the last, developing my ability to communicate, collaborate, and stay safe in digital environments.

Overall, this project provides a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy and prepares students for academic and professional success.

Task 1 - Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Overview

For Task 1, I was asked to create a one-page visual resource to help batchmates understand what Digital Literacy means and why it matters.

Tool Used

To complete this assignment, I used Canva, a program that makes it simple to create infographics using various templates, icons, and layouts, to create an infographic about digital literacy awareness.

What My Design Shows

I created an infographic to help students understand the concept of digital literacy and its significance in today's digital world. The significance of digital tools, internet safety, maintaining a professional online presence, and email etiquette are the primary subjects covered in the infographic I created.

The infographic is designed in a simple yet attractive manner, making it easy for students to comprehend the information provided. The infographics are created in a manner that makes it easy for students to read the information provided in each section of the infographic, including the tips provided at each section of the infographic.

Reflection

The difficulty I encountered while completing the task was choosing the right template of the infographic to incorporate all the information without making it look cluttered. Nevertheless, I was able to manage it effectively by using Canva software.

Task 2 - Digital Portfolio Setup

Overview

Task 2 involved setting up a digital portfolio to showcase my work, skills, and achievements as a Student Digital Ambassador.

Platforms Used

- GITHUB - used for storing and managing code, where I can upload my projects and showcase my technical skills.
- LinkedIn - professional networking platform that helps me build my online presence, connect with professionals, and display my academic and career achievements.
- Kaggle - data science platform that allows me to work with datasets, practice machine learning concepts, and participate in competitions.

Plans

Each of these platforms plays an important role in my learning journey. Over the next four years, I plan to regularly update my GitHub by adding new projects and improving my coding skills. I will enhance my LinkedIn profile by adding certifications, internships, and achievements to build a strong professional identity. On Kaggle, I aim to actively participate in competitions and improve my data analysis and problem-solving abilities.

Overall, these platforms will help me grow academically and professionally while preparing me for future career opportunities.

Task 3 - Exploring Digital Platforms

Overview

For Task 3, I explored a range of digital platforms used in education and professional contexts, documenting my activity and reflecting on their purpose and features.

Platforms Explored

I used HackerRank and Google Forms to explore coding and collaboration platforms. On HackerRank, I created an account and completed a beginner-level coding challenge. This platform helps in improving programming skills and logical thinking through practice problems. It also allows me to track my progress and build confidence in coding.

For collaboration, I used Google Forms to create a digital literacy awareness quiz for my classmates. The form included multiple-choice and short-answer questions related to safe internet practices and digital tools. This helped me understand how digital tools can be used for communication, data collection, and knowledge sharing.

Reflection

These platforms will help me academically by improving my coding skills and enabling me to collaborate effectively with others. Over time, I plan to solve more problems on HackerRank and use Google Forms for surveys, quizzes, and academic projects. Overall, this task enhanced both my technical and communication abilities.

Task 4 - Email Etiquette

Overview

Task 4 required me to demonstrate understanding of professional email communication by drafting sample emails and compiling an etiquette checklist.

Sample Emails Drafted

- Email 1: A formal request to a teacher asking for an extension on a project deadline, using appropriate tone, subject line, and sign-off.
- Email 2: A professional email from a student to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity.

Email Etiquette Checklist

I compiled a checklist of 12 rules covering:

- Subject line clarity - always specific, never left blank
- Greeting format - formal (Dear Mr/Ms) vs semi-formal (Hi [Name])
- Tone - professional, neutral, and free from slang or emojis
- Structure - opening, body, and closing in logical order
- Attachments - named clearly, referenced in the body
- Reply time - within 24 - 48 hours for professional emails

Reflection

A common example of poor digital communication is when a student sends an email to a professor using informal language and without a proper subject line. For instance, writing “Hey sir, send me notes fast” can be considered disrespectful and - unclear. Such communication may create a negative impression and reduce the chances of getting a helpful response.

This situation could have been handled better by using a professional tone, a clear subject line, and polite language. For example, the student should begin with a formal greeting, clearly explain their request, and end with a respectful closing. Proper digital communication reflects professionalism and helps build positive relationships in academic and professional environments.

Task 5 - Cybercrime Awareness

Overview

Task 5 asked me to investigate a real-world cybercrime case study and produce a write-up alongside a personal prevention checklist.

Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

While researching cybercrime, I was surprised to learn how easily people can fall victim to online payment fraud through simple tricks like fake calls and messages. Many users are unaware that sharing an OTP or approving a payment request can lead to immediate financial loss. I realized that even educated individuals can become victims if they are not cautious.

This topic made me more aware of the importance of digital safety and responsible online behavior. One habit I will personally change is to always verify any payment request or message before taking action. I will also avoid clicking on unknown links and ensure that I never share sensitive information like OTPs or PINs with anyone. This awareness will help me stay safe and prevent cyber fraud in the future.

Analysis

This case study highlights how UPI fraud mainly exploits human behaviour rather than technical weaknesses. Attackers rely on urgency, fear, or attractive offers to manipulate users into making quick decisions without proper verification.
The step-by-step process shows that the fraud succeeds only when the victim shares sensitive information (OTP/PIN) or approves a payment request unknowingly. This indicates that lack of awareness and digital literacy is a major contributing factor.
Another important observation is that students and elderly individuals are more vulnerable due to limited experience or over-trust in digital communication. The consequences are not only financial but also psychological, leading to stress and reduced confidence in online systems.
Overall, this case study emphasizes that user awareness is the strongest defense against such cybercrimes. Simple precautions like verifying sources, avoiding unknown links, and understanding how UPI works can significantly reduce the risk of fraud.

Reflection

This task was the most eye-opening of the module. Researching a real incident showed me how sophisticated modern cyberattacks have become the phishing emails in this case were nearly indistinguishable from genuine messages. I also learned that cybersecurity is not just a technical problem but a human one, and education is the most important line of defence.

Conclusion

This project provided me with valuable knowledge and practical experience in digital literacy and its real-world applications. Through the different tasks, I learned how to use digital tools effectively, maintain a professional online presence, and communicate responsibly in the digital environment. I also gained awareness about cyber safety, online fraud, and the importance of protecting personal information.

Each task helped me develop important skills such as problem-solving, communication, and critical thinking. Creating the infographic improved my ability to present information visually, while building a digital portfolio enhanced my professional identity. The coding and collaboration tasks strengthened my technical and teamwork skills, and the email etiquette and cybercrime sections improved my understanding of responsible digital behaviour.

Overall, this project has increased my confidence in using digital technologies and prepared me for future academic and professional challenges. I will continue to apply these skills in my learning journey and ensure safe and ethical use of digital platforms.

References

- Canva - https://www.canva.com
- Google Forms - https://forms.google.com
- HackerRank - https://www.hackerrank.com
- GitHub - https://github.com
- LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com
- Kaggle - https://www.kaggle.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal (India) - https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Online articles and study materials on digital literacy and cyber safety
- Class notes and course materials provided during the module